A-A-51836A
13 February 1989
SUPERSEDING
A-A-0051836 (DM)
7 APRIL 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, EYE SUTURE, STRAIGHT, TWEEZERS-TYPE (Castroviejo)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a straight, tweezers-type eye suture forceps of the Castroviejo design suitable for use in microsurgical eye procedures.

Salient characteristics.

General. The forceps shall be an eye suture forceps of the Castroviejo design with a length of 4 inches. The forceps shall have either 0.12, 0.3 or 0.5 mm teeth, trying platform, wide handles, and interdigitating teeth. When the jaws are closed, there shall be no protruding points. The handles shall have a stop pin, and serrations for a positive grip.

Material. The forceps shall be fabricated from Class 4 martensitic corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with ASTM Designation F899.

Hardness. The forceps shall have a Rockwell Hardness C Scale (HRC) of 42 to 47 when tested in accordance with ASTM Designations E18 or E92 whichever is applicable. Conversion of hardness values shall be in accordance with ASTM Designation E140

Style, design and dimensions. The forceps shall be in accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing No. 23389.

Passivation. The forceps shall be passivated.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515
DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Finish. The forceps shall be mirror, satin, or matte. Should the forceps possess a matte finish, it shall exhibit a uniform, non-directional surface texture equivalent to that produced by lightly blasting the prepared surface with fine abrasives under pressure.

Corrosion resistance. The forceps shall show no evidence of corrosion or plating when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation F1089.

Identification marking. Forceps shall bear the contractor's name of registered trademark and the word "stainless". Forceps of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

Workmanship. The forceps shall be free from cracks, pits, sharp edges, corrosion, foreign matter, or other defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forceps. Sampling shall be Level II and AQL of 1.0%.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The inspection level shall be S-2, with dimensional testing at a 2.5% AQL, hardness testing at a 1.5% AQL, and corrosion testing at a 1.0% AQL. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-115-7667	FORCEPS, EYE SUTURE, Castroviejo, Straight, 0.12 mm Teeth
6515-01-115-7668	FORCEPS, EYE SUTURE, Castroviejo, Straight, 0.3 mm Teeth
6515-01-115-7816	FORCEPS, EYE SUTURE, Castroviejo, Straight, 0.5 mm Teeth

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Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4467

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